Check Whether Dad's Care Plan Is Actually Happening, Using Dated Notes

Four prompts to turn the agreed plan into checkable items, sort your observations by date and source, mark what nobody has seen, and name who follows up on each open item.

Where you are

Dad has had home care for six weeks and you're not there most days. Your sister says it's going fine, your brother thinks the aide skips things, and both of them are going on feeling. Nobody has looked at what the plan actually says.

This guide gives you four ChatGPT prompts to organize what you already know and to see what you don't know yet. It is preparation, not an assessment. Use only information you have permission to share, with names removed. The AI organizes and drafts; it does not diagnose, assess safety, or decide. Bring clinical questions to a clinician, and call emergency services for an emergency.

What you'll have at the end

You can say, item by item, what the plan promised, what someone actually saw and when, and what no one has checked yet.

A one-page care review: What the plan says, What we've seen (with dates), What we haven't seen, and Who follows up.

Before you start

- The current care plan, the agency's service agreement, or whatever written description of the help you have.
- Any notes, texts, or photos from visits over the last two or three weeks, with rough dates.
- A list of who has been in the house and when. You don't need all of it; the gaps are part of what this guide finds.

PROMPT 1

Turn the plan into a list you can check

WHY THIS MATTERS

Most families have never read the care plan as a checklist. It reads as a description of help, not as a set of specific things that should happen on specific days. Until it is a list, you can't compare anything to it.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

The care plan or service agreement, or the closest written thing you have.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is the care plan or service agreement for my father's home care:
>
> [PASTE THE PLAN OR AGREEMENT]

> Turn it into a numbered list of specific, checkable items. For each item give me: what is supposed to happen, how often, who is supposed to do it, and the exact words from the document it comes from. If the document is vague on any point, write VAGUE next to it instead of filling in what you think it probably means. Then list the parts of his daily life the document doesn't mention at all.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A plain checklist, and the places where the plan is vaguer than you remembered.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Ask the agency or care coordinator to clarify the VAGUE items before you review anything else.

PROMPT 2

Sort what you've seen by date and source

WHY THIS MATTERS

Your sense that things are fine, or not fine, is made of a few real observations and a lot of impression. Pulling them apart is uncomfortable and useful. An observation with a date can be discussed; a feeling can only be argued about.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Your notes, texts, photos, and memories from recent visits, with rough dates.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here are my notes, texts, and memories from visits with my father over the last few weeks:
>
> [PASTE YOUR NOTES AND TEXTS]
>
> Put each one into a table with four columns: date, what was observed, who observed it (me, a relative, my father himself, or the aide's own report), and whether it is a direct observation or something someone told us. Where I've written an impression like 'he seemed off' or 'it felt fine,' put it in a separate list called IMPRESSIONS and do not treat it as an observation. Don't tell me what any of this means about the quality of his care.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

How much of what you 'know' turns out to be impression, and how few entries carry a date.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Date every note from today onward, even a one-line text to yourself.

PROMPT 3

Line the two up and mark the empty spaces

WHY THIS MATTERS

When no one was there to see a task happen, the honest answer is 'not observed.' It's not evidence the aide skipped it, and it's not evidence she did it. Families fall both ways, depending on their mood.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

The checklist from Prompt 1 and the table from Prompt 2.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is the checklist from my father's care plan, and here is the table of what we've actually observed:
>
> [PASTE THE PROMPT 1 CHECKLIST]
>
> [PASTE THE PROMPT 2 TABLE]
>
> Match each plan item to any observation that relates to it. Mark each item SEEN HAPPENING, SEEN NOT HAPPENING, or NOT OBSERVED, with the date and source for anything marked seen. Be strict: if nobody was there, it is NOT OBSERVED, not a problem and not a reassurance. Then list the NOT OBSERVED items as questions we could answer by visiting at a different time or by asking someone. Do not conclude whether his care is good or poor.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A short list of plan items no one has actually watched, and a few where what was seen doesn't match what was written.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Pick one NOT OBSERVED item and arrange for someone to be there when it's supposed to happen.

PROMPT 4

Put it on one page with a name beside each follow-up

WHY THIS MATTERS

A review with no owner is a list of complaints. The point of writing a name beside each open item is that it stops being a feeling in the family and becomes a question someone will actually ask.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Everything from the first three prompts and the names of relatives who can realistically help.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is everything I've gathered about my father's care over the last few weeks:
>
> [PASTE EVERYTHING FROM PROMPTS 1 TO 3]
>
> The people who can help are: [NAMES AND WHAT EACH CAN REALISTICALLY DO].
>
> Write one page with four headings: WHAT THE PLAN SAYS, WHAT WE'VE SEEN (with dates), WHAT WE HAVEN'T SEEN, and WHO FOLLOWS UP. Under the last heading, give each open item one owner from my list and a plain next action, such as 'ask the care coordinator' or 'visit on a Tuesday morning.' Keep the wording factual and free of blame. Do not advise whether to change agencies, raise an alarm, or escalate; leave those as questions for the care team and our care consultant.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A page a relative who hasn't been involved could read in two minutes and know what to do.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Send it to the people named on it, and keep your original with the date on it.

Give the review a file to live in

A care review makes more sense next to a clear picture of the person being cared for. The care interview organizes Dad's situation into a Family Care Profile, the starting file that your review notes, and everything that follows them, attach to.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›